The colossus of Sravana Belgola, for a thousand years the tallest free-standing statue in India, commissioned in about 985 CE by a minister of the Western Ganga king Rachamalla IV. It shows the Jain saint Bahubali in standing meditation with vines growing up his limbs, having renounced his kingdom to seek enlightenment. When Benjamin Rice included a photograph of the statue in his book *Mysore and Coorg from the Inscriptions* in 1909, shown here, he added his own version of a fig-leaf.